NCCP 00226 · VERSION 9

Weekly paclitaxel

Paclitaxel on Days 1, 8, 15 and 22 of a 28-day cycle; a Days 1, 8 and 15 schedule may be selected by the consultant. Confirm your appointment plan.

Draft for clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hair

Paclitaxel

Hair loss may affect scalp and body hair. Ask about available support.

2 Mouth

Paclitaxel

Report soreness or ulcers, especially if eating or drinking is affected.

3 Breathing / reaction

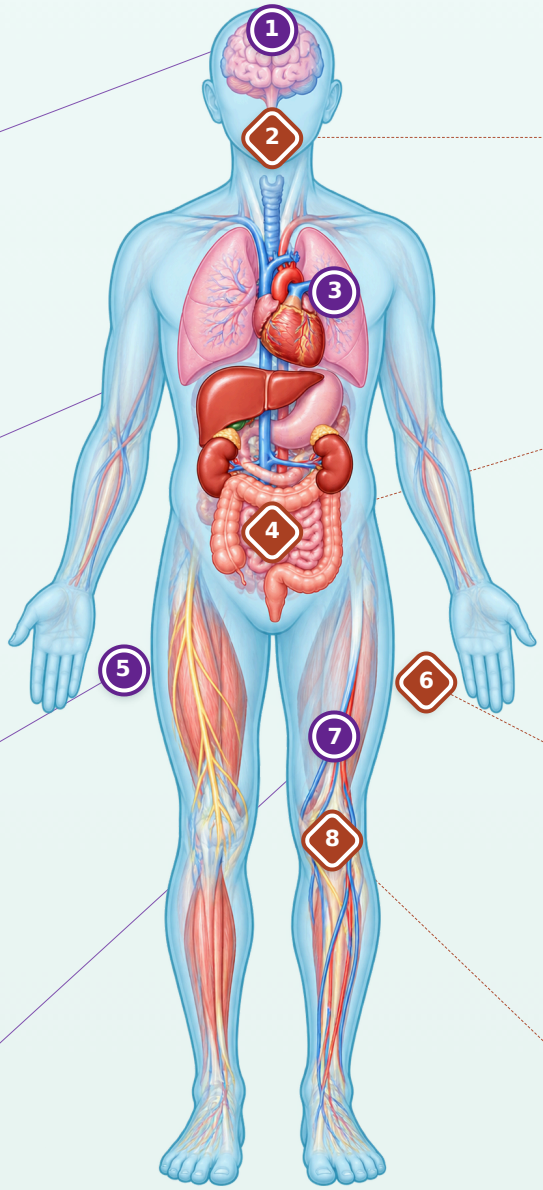
Paclitaxel

Report infusion symptoms immediately. New cough or breathlessness needs review.

4 Bowel

Paclitaxel

Report persistent diarrhoea, vomiting or difficulty maintaining fluids.



5 Nerves

Paclitaxel

Report numbness, tingling, weakness or loss of hand function before the next dose.

6 Skin / nails

Paclitaxel

Painful nail changes, spreading rash, blistering or infection need advice.

7 Blood / infection

Paclitaxel

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: contact oncology immediately.

8 Muscles / joints

Paclitaxel

Aches can follow treatment. Describe pain and how it affects normal activity.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts / infection
- Sensory or motor neuropathy, potentially persistent
- Hypersensitivity / infusion reaction
- Hair loss and nail / skin changes
- Muscle and joint aches
- Fatigue and mouth / bowel symptoms
- Rare serious lung or cardiac effects

Make the plan practical

Premedication for infusion reactions

Steroid and antihistamine premedication reduce the chance or severity of reactions. The team may adjust premedication after tolerated doses. Do not omit or change it yourself; tell the nurse about missed doses.

Aches, nausea and bowel support

Agree a pain-relief and anti-sickness plan. Ask before taking new medicines. Uncontrolled pain or poor intake needs review. Some supportive medicines cause constipation or drowsiness.

Nerve symptoms and fall prevention

Use secure footwear and take care with balance, hot surfaces and sharp objects if sensation is reduced. Tell the team early about functional changes; persistent neuropathy may influence dosing.

Hair, nails and skin

Ask about hair-loss support and whether scalp cooling is appropriate and available. Protect sensitive nails and skin. Report painful nail changes, spreading rash, blistering or infection.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00226/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.